

'make-or-break' one for Arsenal. A modern football team is remembered for its silverware, and the only significant trophy Arteta can boast of is an FA Cup. The Gunners have already shown intent by signing Italian centre-back Riccardo Calafiori from Bologna.

Indulging in smart buys and creating a proper footballing structure — that is what INEOS promised when it took charge of Manchester United's football operations, acquiring a 25 per cent stake in the club. So far, lifelong United fan Jim Ratcliffe and his team have shown intent.

Sticking with head coach Erik ten Hag, the club has appointed Omar Berrada and Dan Ashworth as Chief Executive of Football Operations and Sporting Director, respectively. With signings like Leny Yoro (18) and Joshua Zirkzee (23), United has begun its new philosophy of investing in future talents with a high growth ceiling.

It is tough to ascertain how Chelsea and Liverpool will fare in the coming season. Both will be under new managers — Enzo Maresca and Arne Slot, respectively. Slot has been successful in the Netherlands, winning the Eredivisie with Feyenoord, but that will not guarantee automatic success in

England — just ask Ten Hag. Chelsea, too, has gambled by appointing Maresca after relieving Mauricio Pochettino of his duties — a manager who has operated in the Premier League at a high level. Additionally, both teams have yet to properly dip their toes into the transfer market.

Leicester City, Ipswich Town, and Southampton will be the newly promoted teams in the Premier League. Leicester, champion in the 2015-16 season, and Southampton have been familiar faces in the Premier League over the years, in contrast to Ipswich, who makes a return after 22 years.

Under the able guidance of Kieran McKenna, Ipswich has grabbed headlines with its football but will hope its season does not turn out like Luton Town's, who failed to survive promotion.

La Liga

Mbappé to Real Madrid — undoubtedly one of the most dramatic transfer sagas in modern football, spanning over eight years — came to an end after the Frenchman signed a five-year deal with Los Blancos on a free transfer from Paris Saint-Germain.

If that wasn't a statement in itself, the defending champion will also have Brazilian wonder-kid Endrick in its ranks after the 18-year-old's move from Palmeiras.

Add present stars like Jude Bellingham and Vinícius Júnior into the mix, and it might seem that Madrid is destined to win it all.

However, look back to the early 2000s during the Galácticos era, and you'll realise that football is never black and white. Carlo Ancelotti will be responsible for making these players click as a unit and handling some big egos in the dressing room.

Seeing the Madrid storm in the transfer market, it's understandable that Barcelona fans might be nervous about the coming season. But all hope is not lost for the Catalans.

Despite being rocked by financial turbulence, the presence of Lamine Yamal will provide hope to the Barça faithful. Fresh from winning Euro 2024 and being adjudged 'Young Player of the Tournament,' there will be major expectations on him to help Barcelona mount a title challenge — probably more than what should be pinned on a 17-year-old.

But, with an able manager in Hansi Flick, all hope is not lost. It is difficult to see Atletico Madrid in the thick of things as far as a title charge is concerned. However, with Argentine striker Julián Álvarez joining from City, that will provide a major boost for Simeone and his men.

Valladolid, Leganés, and Espanyol will be the newly promoted teams in La Liga next season.

Bundesliga

Will Harry Kane finally win a major trophy? That is the burning question ahead of next season. Kane's title drought seemed over when he joined serial champion Bayern Munich last summer.

However, under Xabi Alonso, Bayer Leverkusen had a monumental season, staying undefeated for 51 games and ending Bayern's 11-year reign at the top. Now, it remains to be seen whether Alonso can carry on the momentum.

Bayern turned heads by appointing Vincent Kompany as head coach, given the fact that his CV as a coach does not boast any significant



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